

e-learning. But with an industry that is already thriving, and a future this promising, one must surely wonder the different career opportunities in e-learning, and what they have to offer. Even though authoring a primitive e-learning course can be done on your own, surely the different elements that an effective e-learning course comprises of, call for a team of varying job profiles handling it. In general developing an effective e-learning course would require for a team to have the following members:

- ▶ **E-learning instructor:** This one is a bit obvious. We're talking about a candidate with the mastery of the course content who is also an effective communicator so as to be able to teach the course content accurately and clearly.
- ▶ **Subject Matter Expert (SME):** Someone who's a content expert. More often than not, the e-learning instructors tend to be the SMEs for courses, especially MOOCs. However in courses where there aren't video tutorials or the presence of a teacher of any kind, SMEs are responsible for the entire content matter of the course.
- ▶ **Technical writer/editor:** Someone who is responsible for the content of the course material by effectively gathering information from the SMEs, and at times also publishing the material online. Apart from knowing tools such as Acrobat, Framemaker etc., the tech writer often needs to learn to develop web pages as well.
- ▶ **Graphic designer/Multimedia developer:** These guys are responsible for the user interface of the course. Not only are they responsible for its usability, they also are responsible for creating/editing videos, flash movies, or any other 'activities' for students that involves graphic designing. These two roles are usually undertaken by the same person, but in a few cases there are separate people assigned for the both of them
- ▶ **Instructional Designer:** There are more jobs for instructional designers than for any other category in e-learning. Instructional designers or IDs - as they are often called - are the people who combine an understanding of the science of learning with an ability to put the available media, methods and tools to work in the most effective, efficient manner possible. IDs are supposed to know how people learn and are in turn expected to affect these into the final result that is the course content, and the overall experience of the students taking it. IDs get to work in a challenging, learning environment and tend to work long hours often taking up responsibilities that don't necessarily come under their job description. Many e-learning project teams run with only an SME and